

Alexis Montenegro, MBA

Executive Portfolio

**Marketing Operations • Revenue Operations • Business Systems • AI
& Operational Strategy**

**Building scalable systems that connect marketing, technology, and
business operations.**

"Technology should make organizations easier to operate, not more complicated."

About This Portfolio

Marketing is often evaluated through campaigns, creative assets, and lead generation. While I've led work in all of those areas, my career has increasingly focused on something less visible: **building the operational systems that make sustainable growth possible.**

Over the past several years, I've worked at the intersection of **marketing, technology, and business operations**, helping organizations improve how they manage information, automate processes, measure performance, and scale. Whether [implementing a CRM](#), [redesigning lead routing](#), [developing an attribution framework](#), [introducing AI into everyday workflows](#), or [leading enterprise software implementations](#), my approach has remained consistent. **Start by understanding the business problem, then design systems that make it easier for people to do their best work.**

This portfolio isn't intended to be a comprehensive history of every project I've led. Instead, it's a collection of initiatives that best represent **how I think, how I solve problems, and how I lead change.** Some chapters focus on technology, others on marketing or operations, but they're all connected by the same objective: creating systems that are practical, scalable, and built to support long-term business goals.

If you choose to read it from beginning to end, you'll see how each project built on the one before it, gradually creating a more connected and measurable marketing operation. If you're skimming, I encourage you to jump to the chapters that align most closely with your interests. Each one stands on its own while reflecting the same operating principles that have guided my work throughout my career.

At the heart of every project are five simple ideas:

- **Understand the business problem.**
- **Design for scale.**
- **Use technology intentionally.**
- **Measure what matters.**
- **Keep improving.**

The tools will continue to change. Those principles won't.

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Executive Profile

I build the operational systems that help marketing organizations scale.

Over the years, my work has expanded beyond traditional marketing into **marketing operations, revenue operations, CRM strategy, business systems, automation, AI, analytics, and process improvement**. While the technology has changed from project to project, the underlying challenge has been remarkably consistent: organizations grow faster than their systems do.

That's the type of problem I enjoy solving.

Before recommending software or redesigning a process, I spend time understanding how the business actually operates. Where does work slow down? Which decisions rely on assumptions instead of data? Where are teams creating unnecessary manual work? Those questions usually reveal the real problem, and they often lead to a very different solution than what was originally expected.

That approach has shaped everything from [CRM implementations](#) and [marketing attribution](#) to [AI-assisted workflows](#), enterprise software rollouts, and cross-functional process improvements. In many cases, the technology itself wasn't the most significant part of the project. The lasting impact came from giving people better information, reducing operational friction, and creating systems that were easier to maintain as the organization grew.

I enjoy working on problems that don't have obvious answers. Those projects require more than technical knowledge. They require listening, asking good questions, building consensus, and finding solutions that balance business needs with the realities of day-to-day operations. *That's where I do my best work.*

Core Areas of Expertise

Marketing Operations

Building scalable marketing systems that improve execution, reduce manual work, and provide clearer visibility into performance.

- Marketing technology strategy
- Campaign operations
- Lifecycle marketing
- Workflow automation
- Lead management
- Process improvement

Revenue Operations

Connecting marketing and sales through CRM strategy, reporting, automation, and operational alignment.

- CRM architecture
- Lead routing
- Sales process optimization
- Marketing attribution
- Pipeline reporting
- Executive dashboards

Business Systems

Designing, implementing, and continuously improving the technology that supports day-to-day business operations.

- HubSpot administration
- Systems integration
- Automation design
- Vendor management
- Software implementation
- Change management

AI & Operational Productivity

Applying AI to improve documentation, knowledge management, research, reporting, and operational efficiency while keeping people at the center of decision-making.

- AI-assisted workflows
- Organizational knowledge management
- Documentation systems
- SOP development
- Prompt engineering
- Process optimization

Analytics & Growth

Using data to guide marketing investment, improve customer acquisition, and measure business outcomes.

- Marketing reporting
- SEO strategy
- Google Ads
- Meta Ads
- Technical SEO
- Conversion optimization

How I Approach Marketing Operations

Marketing Operations is often associated with software, automation, and reporting. Those are certainly part of the role, but I see them as outputs rather than the starting point. **The real work is understanding how information moves through an organization and removing the friction that slows people down.**

That's why I rarely begin with technology.

When I'm evaluating a process, I usually start with a handful of questions:

- Where does work slow down?
- Which tasks are consuming time without adding value?
- What information do people wish they had?
- Where are decisions being made based on assumptions instead of reliable data?

The answers almost always point toward the right solution. Sometimes that solution involves new technology. Other times it's a process change, clearer documentation, or simply connecting systems that already exist.

Building Systems, Not Just Solutions

Every project in this portfolio started with a different business problem, but they all followed a similar pattern.

[The HubSpot implementation](#) created a centralized system for managing leads and reporting. That foundation made it possible to build a [meaningful attribution framework](#), which later improved how paid media was measured and optimized. The lifecycle communication strategy relied on the CRM architecture established during that implementation, while the [lead assignment system](#) extended it by improving how quickly new inquiries reached the right people. Even [my work with AI](#) has focused less on experimenting with new tools and more on reducing repetitive work, improving documentation, and making information easier to find.

Each project solved an immediate need, but I was also thinking about what it would enable next. I try to avoid building isolated solutions. Whenever possible, I want each improvement to strengthen the broader operational ecosystem.

Keeping People at the Center

Technology only creates value if people actually use it.

That's why I spend as much time thinking about adoption as implementation. A technically perfect solution won't succeed if it disrupts established workflows or creates unnecessary complexity. On the other hand, a simpler solution that fits naturally into the way people already work is far more likely to become part of the organization's day-to-day operations.

I've found that the best systems don't call attention to themselves. They quietly remove manual work, improve visibility, and help people make better decisions without forcing them to think about the technology behind the scenes.

The projects in this portfolio span CRM strategy, marketing operations, AI, automation, analytics, and organizational change, but they're all connected by the same objective: **building systems that help people work more effectively while giving leaders better information to make decisions.**

Those ideas shape every project in this portfolio, but they become most visible when organizations are going through change. Introducing new technology is rarely the hardest part of an implementation. Building trust, creating alignment, and helping people adopt new ways of working are often the real challenges. The first case study explores how I approach that process.

Leading Organizational Change Through Technology

Executive Summary

Technology projects rarely fail because of the technology itself. More often, they struggle because people weren't involved early enough, processes weren't clearly defined, or the organization never fully adopted the new way of working. Throughout my career, I've found that successful implementations depend just as much on communication, governance, and trust as they do on technical expertise.

This chapter highlights how I've approached organizational change across [CRM implementations](#), AI adoption, and enterprise software rollouts by focusing on the people using the systems, not just the systems themselves.

Start with the Business Problem

When I'm asked to evaluate a new platform or improve an existing process, my first question is rarely, *"Which software should we buy?"*

Instead, I want to understand the business problem we're trying to solve.

What isn't working today? Where are teams experiencing friction? Is technology actually the answer, or can the problem be solved by simplifying a process or improving communication?

I've found that those conversations often lead to better decisions than starting with a list of software features. Every new platform introduces cost, complexity, training requirements, and ongoing maintenance. Sometimes a new system is absolutely the right investment. Other times, improving an existing process creates more value than introducing another application.

That way of thinking has shaped nearly every project in this portfolio. The CRM implementation was designed around the firm's existing sales process rather than forcing teams to adapt to the software. [The lead assignment system](#) was built using tools we already owned instead of purchasing another platform. More recently, [my approach to AI](#) has centered on improving documentation, knowledge management,

and day-to-day productivity rather than adopting new technology simply because it was available.

Leading the monday.com Implementation

One of the largest organizational change initiatives I've led was the implementation of monday.com at GoodLeap.

At the time, roughly twenty members of the marketing organization were managing work across several disconnected platforms, including Smartsheet, Jira, Google Sheets, and, in some cases, no formal project management system at all. As the organization grew, it became increasingly difficult to understand priorities, coordinate work across teams, or provide leadership with a clear view of ongoing initiatives.

It would have been easy to recommend a standardized solution and ask everyone to adapt.

Instead, I started by listening.

I met with each functional team to understand how they managed projects, where existing workflows created friction, and which capabilities they felt were missing. Those conversations shaped the implementation strategy far more than any software demonstration could have.

Rather than replacing every existing process, I looked for opportunities to preserve what already worked while creating greater consistency across the organization. That approach not only reduced resistance to change, but also strengthened executive support because the implementation reflected the needs of the teams who would ultimately be using it.

The initial proposal wasn't approved immediately. Rather than treating that as a setback, I continued refining the business case, incorporating stakeholder feedback, and demonstrating how a shared project management platform could improve visibility, collaboration, and operational efficiency. Once leadership approved the initiative, implementation moved forward with broad organizational support instead of reluctant compliance.

Driving Adoption

Rolling out new software is only one part of an implementation.

Long-term success depends on governance, documentation, training, and helping people understand why the change matters.

I've consistently found that adoption improves when employees see technology solving problems they experience every day. New software shouldn't feel like another responsibility. It should eliminate unnecessary work and make collaboration easier.

That philosophy influenced how I approached training as well. Rather than relying on lengthy presentations or large procedural manuals, I created practical documentation and short instructional guides using Tango so employees could learn new workflows when they actually needed them.

Documentation has become one of the most valuable parts of my work because it does more than explain a process. It often exposes opportunities to improve it.

As workflows are documented, unnecessary complexity becomes easier to identify, missing steps become obvious, and opportunities for automation naturally emerge. More recently, AI tools such as ChatGPT and Wispr Flow have made that process even more effective by helping me quickly capture ideas and transform them into polished standard operating procedures, implementation guides, and training materials.

Building Systems That Last

Well-designed systems should never depend on one person.

Clear documentation makes onboarding easier, preserves institutional knowledge, and allows teams to continue operating effectively as people and responsibilities change. The same principle applies to governance. As organizations grow, workflows, reports, dashboards, automations, and custom properties have a tendency to multiply. Without regular review, even successful systems become difficult to maintain.

I've learned that simpler environments are usually more resilient. Whenever possible, I reduce unnecessary complexity, establish consistent standards, and periodically review systems to ensure they continue supporting the business instead of creating additional administrative work.

The same approach extends to vendor relationships. Whether working with implementation consultants, software providers, or external agencies, I focus on maintaining clear communication, documenting decisions, and keeping business objectives at the center of every conversation.

What Success Looks Like

The best implementations I've been part of all have one thing in common.

People wanted to use them.

That has become my measure of success. Not how many workflows were built or how many licenses were purchased, but whether the technology became a natural part of how the organization worked.

When that happens, adoption follows naturally. Teams spend less time working around their systems and more time using them to solve business problems, collaborate effectively, and make better decisions.

Project at a Glance

Primary Focus

Organizational Change & Business Systems

Key Initiatives

- Enterprise implementation of monday.com
- CRM adoption and governance
- AI-assisted documentation
- Process standardization
- Cross-functional change management

Core Capabilities

- Stakeholder engagement
- Business process analysis
- Change management
- Documentation and training

- Governance
- Vendor management

Business Impact

- Improved cross-functional visibility
- Greater user adoption
- Standardized workflows
- Better documentation and knowledge sharing
- More sustainable business systems

Building a Modern CRM and Revenue Operations Foundation

Executive Summary

As the firm's marketing efforts expanded, it became increasingly difficult to answer basic business questions with confidence. Leadership wanted greater visibility into marketing performance, Sales needed a more consistent process for managing prospective clients, and manual reporting was becoming increasingly difficult to maintain. This project focused on designing a CRM that aligned Marketing, Booking, and Intake around a shared operating model while creating the foundation for reporting, automation, and future operational initiatives.

Recognizing the Need for a Dedicated CRM

When I joined the firm, prospective clients and active cases were both managed in MyCase.

It was an effective case management platform once someone became a client, but it wasn't designed to support marketing operations or the sales process before retention. As a result, answering seemingly straightforward questions required manual effort.

Which campaigns generated qualified consultations?

How quickly were prospective clients contacted?

Where were leads dropping out of the sales process?

Which marketing investments consistently produced new clients?

Marketing could see lead volume, but connecting those leads to downstream business outcomes was much more difficult. Reporting often relied on spreadsheets, and each new request required additional manual work. As marketing expanded, those limitations became more apparent. Leadership needed reliable data to guide investment decisions, and the business needed a system built specifically for lead management.

Designing Around the Business

After evaluating several platforms, I recommended HubSpot.

The firm had previously worked with Salesforce, but it wasn't the right fit for the organization. What stood out to me about HubSpot wasn't simply its feature set. It gave us the flexibility to build the CRM around the way the business already operated instead of asking teams to redesign their workflows around the software.

Rather than replacing MyCase, I positioned the two platforms to serve different purposes.

HubSpot became the system for Marketing and Sales, while MyCase remained the system of record for active client matters. That separation created cleaner reporting, reduced overlap, and gave each platform a well-defined role throughout the client journey.

Before configuring the CRM, I mapped the firm's sales process from the initial inquiry through client retention. I wanted to understand how information moved between Marketing, Booking, and Intake before deciding how the system should be structured.

That process identified the data each team relied on, where handoffs occurred, which tasks could be automated, and what leadership needed to measure. It also influenced the reporting strategy. Rather than treating dashboards as something to build after implementation, I designed the CRM so meaningful reporting would be available from the day it launched.

Building the Platform

Implementing the CRM involved far more than configuring software.

I evaluated the platform, secured executive approval, designed the CRM architecture, created custom properties, built lifecycle stages, developed more than **100 automated workflows**, implemented **15 Zapier integrations**, documented operational processes, trained users, and continue to administer and optimize the platform today. The implementation supports approximately **40 users** and manages **more than 55,000 contacts**.

Because the organization operates across New York, Massachusetts, Honduras, Mexico, and the Dominican Republic, documentation and training were essential to long-term adoption. Clear processes helped establish consistency across distributed teams while reducing the learning curve for new users.

I also integrated tools employees already relied on, including Slack and Google Sheets, rather than replacing them. Keeping familiar tools in place reduced friction during rollout and allowed the CRM to strengthen existing workflows instead of disrupting them.

Creating Operational Visibility

The most significant outcome wasn't automation.

It was visibility.

For the first time, Marketing and Sales shared reliable data around campaign performance, lead attribution, conversion rates, response times, and return on marketing investment. Leadership no longer depended on manually assembled reports to understand how marketing contributed to the business.

The CRM also standardized lead management across Booking and Intake, reduced administrative work through automation, and established consistent governance for customer data. It became the operational foundation for future initiatives including [attribution reporting](#), [lifecycle marketing](#), [lead routing](#), and [CRM-based paid media optimization](#). Each of those projects built on the architecture established during this implementation.

Building for the Long Term

One of the decisions I'm most satisfied with wasn't a technical feature.

It was resisting the temptation to build everything at once.

The initial implementation focused on creating a stable foundation with clear lifecycle stages, standardized data, reliable reporting, and automation that solved immediate business needs. That made it possible to expand the platform incrementally as new priorities emerged without repeatedly redesigning the underlying architecture.

Today, the CRM continues to evolve, but the core design principles remain unchanged: support the way the business operates, keep the system maintainable, and provide leadership with information they can trust.

Project at a Glance

Primary Focus

CRM Strategy & Revenue Operations

Core Capabilities

- CRM architecture
- Lifecycle design
- Workflow automation
- Data governance
- Executive reporting
- Sales process optimization
- User training and adoption

Platform

- HubSpot CRM
- Slack
- Google Sheets
- Zapier

Business Outcomes

- Implemented a dedicated CRM for Marketing and Sales
- Standardized lead management across Booking and Intake
- Built **100+ workflows** and **15 Zapier integrations**
- Supports **55,000+ contacts** and approximately **40 users**
- Established the operational foundation for attribution, lifecycle marketing, lead routing, and paid media optimization

Building an AI Operating System

Executive Summary

AI has become a regular part of many workplaces, but I've found the greatest value isn't in generating content. It's in creating systems that organize knowledge, preserve context, and reduce the time spent searching for information. Rather than treating AI as a standalone tool, I've integrated it into my daily workflows to support documentation, technical research, executive reporting, and operational decision-making while keeping human judgment at the center of every recommendation.

Moving Beyond Content Generation

Like many professionals, I initially experimented with AI for writing assistance and brainstorming.

It didn't take long to realize I was solving the wrong problem.

Writing wasn't the bottleneck. Finding information was.

Marketing Operations generates a constant stream of knowledge. Meeting transcripts, project documentation, emails, Slack conversations, technical research, implementation notes, and reporting all contain valuable context. The challenge isn't creating that information. It's being able to retrieve the right detail weeks or months later without manually searching through multiple systems.

That realization changed the way I approached AI. Instead of viewing it as another productivity application, I began designing an operating model that treated information as a shared organizational asset rather than a collection of disconnected documents.

Creating an Organizational Memory

One of the first workflows I built focused on knowledge management.

I created a centralized process where meeting transcripts, project documentation, emails, and supporting materials could be referenced through natural language instead

of traditional file searches. Rather than trying to remember where information was stored, I could ask questions like:

- *What decisions were made during last week's implementation meeting?*
- *Where did we leave off before this project was paused?*
- *Which blockers were identified during planning?*

The practical benefit wasn't simply convenience. It reduced the cognitive overhead of managing multiple initiatives at once and made it easier to pick projects back up with their full context intact. That has become increasingly valuable as my responsibilities have expanded across CRM administration, automation, reporting, paid media, vendor management, and leadership.

Using AI as a Technical Partner

AI has also become an effective technical collaborator.

I don't consider myself a software engineer, but many operational challenges require technical problem-solving. During projects like the [lead assignment system](#), I used AI to research platform capabilities, validate workflow logic, troubleshoot implementation issues, and assist with JavaScript while remaining responsible for defining business requirements, evaluating recommendations, and making implementation decisions.

That distinction matters.

AI can generate possibilities. It doesn't understand organizational priorities, business constraints, or the tradeoffs involved in a real implementation. Those decisions still require experience and judgment. I see AI as a partner that accelerates exploration, not one that replaces accountability.

Improving Executive Communication

Another area where AI has had a meaningful impact is executive reporting.

By connecting information from monday.com, Slack, Gmail, meeting transcripts, and ongoing project documentation, I created a workflow that helps generate structured weekly marketing updates in the format preferred by the firm's CEO.

Instead of manually gathering updates from several platforms, I spend my time reviewing priorities, validating information, and refining the message. Leadership receives concise summaries focused on progress, roadblocks, upcoming priorities, and decisions requiring executive attention, while I spend less time assembling reports and more time driving the work behind them.

Documentation at Scale

Documentation has always been one of the highest-return investments I can make in a project.

Using Wispr Flow together with ChatGPT, I can explain a process verbally while AI converts those ideas into structured standard operating procedures, implementation guides, troubleshooting documentation, and training materials.

Because those workflows also reference supporting project information and meeting history, they often surface implementation details that would otherwise be missed during manual documentation. The result isn't simply faster documentation. It's documentation that's more complete and easier to maintain over time.

Keeping People in Control

Throughout all of these workflows, one principle has remained consistent.

AI should support professional judgment, not replace it.

Every recommendation is reviewed in the context of business objectives, organizational priorities, and practical experience before implementation. I also work with Human Resources to ensure AI workflows align with organizational expectations around security, privacy, and responsible use, while sharing practical guidance with colleagues interested in adopting these tools effectively.

What has changed most isn't the speed of my work. It's where I spend my attention.

Research that once took hours can often be completed in minutes. Documentation is easier to maintain. Technical challenges can be explored more efficiently. Most importantly, I spend more time solving business problems and less time recreating

work or searching for information. That shift has been the real value of AI in my day-to-day work.

Project at a Glance

Primary Focus

AI Strategy, Knowledge Management & Operational Productivity

Core Capabilities

- AI-assisted research
- Organizational knowledge management
- Executive reporting
- SOP development
- Technical troubleshooting
- Workflow design
- Prompt engineering

Primary Tools

- ChatGPT
- Wispr Flow
- Fathom
- Zapier
- Gmail
- Google Drive
- Slack
- monday.com

Business Outcomes

- Reduced content production time by **60%**
- More complete and maintainable documentation
- Faster research and technical problem-solving
- Streamlined executive reporting
- Stronger knowledge preservation across projects

Transforming Marketing Measurement Through Attribution

Executive Summary

As the firm's marketing investment grew, leadership needed more than campaign reports. They needed confidence that marketing dollars were producing meaningful business outcomes. This project focused on building a measurement framework that connected advertising platforms, [CRM data](#), and sales activity, giving every team a shared view of performance and creating a stronger foundation for future optimization.

The Measurement Gap

Marketing teams rarely struggle because they don't have enough data.

More often, they struggle because the data doesn't answer the questions the business is asking.

When I joined the firm, we could measure website activity, advertising metrics, and digital form submissions, but our reporting stopped short of the outcomes leadership cared about most. Which campaigns generated consultations? Which produced retained clients? Where were prospective clients dropping out of the sales process? Which marketing investments consistently delivered the highest-quality opportunities?

Phone calls presented the biggest challenge. They represented one of the firm's primary intake channels, yet they couldn't be reliably connected to individual marketing campaigns. Instead, attribution often depended on asking prospective clients how they found the firm. While that provided some insight, it wasn't detailed enough to distinguish paid traffic from organic traffic or evaluate individual campaigns with confidence.

Designing a Measurement Framework

Rather than treating attribution as another marketing report, I approached it as an operational system.

The first priority was standardization.

I developed a consistent campaign taxonomy across Google Ads, Meta Ads, SEO, referral sources, and other marketing initiatives so every campaign followed the same naming structure. From there, I implemented standardized UTM parameters to preserve source information as contacts moved into the CRM. Cleaner inputs meant more reliable reporting later in the customer journey.

The remaining challenge was phone call attribution.

After evaluating several platforms, I recommended CallRail because it integrated well with our CRM and supported the level of campaign reporting we needed. I designed the attribution framework, integrated the platform with HubSpot, built supporting workflows, collaborated on the Zoom Contact Center implementation, and developed campaign-level reporting that connected inbound calls to individual marketing initiatives.

Earning Executive Support

Not every recommendation is approved the first time.

My initial proposal to implement CallRail raised legitimate concerns around client experience, brand consistency, and the risks of introducing multiple public-facing phone numbers. Rather than pushing for an immediate decision, I continued documenting the reporting limitations we faced and showed how those gaps affected conversations about marketing performance.

As those discussions continued, the business case became stronger. Instead of proposing a broad rollout, we adopted a phased implementation. Dynamic Number Insertion was limited to Google Ads traffic while organic visitors continued seeing the firm's primary phone number. Separate numbers were assigned to Facebook and Instagram campaigns to improve reporting without disrupting the client experience. That compromise addressed leadership's concerns while still delivering the measurement capabilities we needed.

Creating a Shared View of Performance

The greatest value of the project wasn't a new dashboard.

It was creating a shared understanding of performance across the organization.

Marketing could evaluate campaign quality instead of lead volume alone. Booking and Intake gained better visibility into response times and conversion rates. Leadership could compare marketing investments using consistent business data instead of isolated platform reports.

Conversations shifted naturally. Instead of debating which numbers were correct, teams could focus on improving results because everyone was working from the same measurement framework. Attribution became less about reporting and more about supporting better decisions across Marketing, Sales, and executive leadership.

Laying the Foundation for What Came Next

This work also enabled the projects that followed.

When the firm later [transitioned paid advertising from an external agency to an internal operation](#), the measurement framework was already in place. Campaign optimization no longer depended solely on clicks, impressions, or platform-reported conversions. We could evaluate advertising using CRM data and downstream business outcomes, giving us a much stronger foundation for optimization and investment decisions.

The framework continues to evolve as new campaigns, services, and reporting needs are introduced, but the underlying objective has remained the same: provide reliable information that helps the business make better decisions.

Project at a Glance

Primary Focus

Marketing Measurement & Attribution Strategy

Core Capabilities

- Attribution strategy
- Campaign taxonomy
- UTM governance
- Executive dashboard design

- CRM reporting
- Cross-functional analytics

Key Platforms

- HubSpot
- CallRail
- Google Analytics 4
- Looker Studio
- Google Ads
- Meta Ads
- Zoom Contact Center

Business Outcomes

- Standardized campaign measurement
- Phone call attribution across paid channels
- Cross-functional reporting consistency
- Improved executive visibility into marketing ROI
- Foundation for CRM-based paid media optimization

Modernizing Paid Media with CRM-Based Optimization

Executive Summary

Bringing paid media in-house wasn't simply a change in ownership. It was an opportunity to rethink how advertising decisions were made. By connecting Google Ads, Meta Ads, CRM data, and sales outcomes, the organization shifted from optimizing campaigns around platform metrics to optimizing them around business performance.

Why Bring Paid Media In-House?

Many organizations rely on agencies to manage paid advertising, and there are situations where that model makes sense. By this point, however, our marketing operation had matured considerably.

We had already [implemented a CRM](#), standardized lifecycle stages, and [built a measurement framework](#) that connected campaigns to consultations, retained clients, and other downstream outcomes. For the first time, we had reliable data that reflected how marketing contributed to the business.

The missing piece wasn't reporting.

It was ownership.

Leadership wanted greater transparency, faster optimization, and the ability to make advertising decisions using the same business data that guided the rest of the organization. Bringing paid media in-house created the opportunity to build that capability.

Strengthening the Foundation First

It was tempting to start by rebuilding campaigns.

Instead, I focused on understanding what already existed.

I audited the Google Ads and Meta Ads accounts, reviewed campaign structures, evaluated conversion tracking, refreshed my knowledge of current platform capabilities, and met with the CEO to understand how leadership defined success.

That conversation shaped the entire project.

Advertising platforms naturally optimize toward the signals they receive. If those signals are limited to clicks, form submissions, or low-quality conversions, that's what the platforms will pursue. I wanted campaign optimization to reflect the outcomes that actually mattered to the business: qualified leads, booked consultations, retained clients, and return on marketing investment.

Connecting Advertising to Business Outcomes

Rather than relying on native platform reporting alone, I integrated Google Ads and Meta Ads with the CRM, CallRail, and Zoom Contact Center.

I then configured offline conversion tracking so meaningful milestones throughout the customer journey were sent back to the advertising platforms. Instead of treating every lead equally, conversion events reflected the quality of each opportunity, allowing the platforms to learn from outcomes farther down the funnel.

That changed the role of paid media.

Campaign optimization was no longer driven primarily by advertising metrics. It became an extension of the broader revenue operations strategy, using CRM data to improve marketing performance over time.

Managing the Transition

I also wanted to minimize disruption while bringing the program in-house.

Rather than replacing every campaign at once, I developed a phased migration strategy. Existing campaigns continued running while I cleaned account structures, improved tracking, and built replacement campaigns in parallel. Once new campaigns had been reviewed and tested, traffic was transitioned gradually.

This approach protected lead volume during the transition while giving Google's and Meta's optimization models time to learn from the improved conversion data. It also reduced organizational risk by avoiding unnecessary changes before the supporting measurement infrastructure was fully in place.

Using Data to Guide Investment

One of the most valuable outcomes wasn't a new dashboard or a lower cost per click.

It was the ability to make better investment decisions.

As campaign data accumulated, patterns began to emerge that weren't visible through platform reporting alone. By combining CRM attribution with phone call data, I identified that Meta Lead Form campaigns consistently generated higher-quality opportunities than Meta Call Now campaigns.

That insight led to a strategic shift in budget allocation. Rather than distributing spend evenly across campaign types, we increased investment in Lead Form campaigns and retired the Call Now strategy.

The decision wasn't based on assumptions or platform recommendations. It was supported by CRM data that reflected actual business outcomes.

Building an Internal Capability

One of the long-term advantages of bringing paid media in-house has been agility.

Campaign structures, creative testing, conversion tracking, audience strategy, reporting, and budget adjustments can all be refined without waiting on an outside agency. Leadership has greater visibility into performance, optimization cycles are shorter, and marketing decisions stay closely aligned with changing business priorities.

More importantly, paid media is no longer operating independently from Marketing Operations. It has become part of the same connected system that includes CRM management, attribution, reporting, automation, and sales performance. That alignment continues to improve as more historical data becomes available and optimization models become more accurate.

Project at a Glance

Primary Focus

Paid Media Strategy & CRM-Based Optimization

Core Capabilities

- Google Ads and Meta Ads management
- CRM-based conversion tracking
- Offline conversion optimization
- Campaign restructuring
- Executive reporting
- Budget optimization

Integrated Platforms

- Google Ads
- Meta Ads
- HubSpot
- CallRail
- Zoom Contact Center

Business Outcomes

- Brought paid media management in-house
- Connected advertising platforms directly to CRM data
- Implemented offline conversion tracking based on qualified business outcomes
- Improved executive visibility into advertising performance
- Created a scalable optimization framework that continues to improve over time

Building a Scalable Organic Growth Engine

Executive Summary

Search engine optimization is often treated as a series of technical tasks. In practice, sustainable growth comes from building a repeatable process that combines measurement, technical improvements, content strategy, and continuous optimization. This project focused on transforming SEO from a reactive activity into an operational capability that supports both local and national growth.

Understanding the Opportunity

When I joined the firm, organic search already generated meaningful traffic, but there wasn't a structured strategy guiding future growth.

Performance was measured inconsistently, technical improvements were largely reactive, and there was limited visibility into how the firm compared with competitors or where the greatest opportunities existed. As marketing matured, SEO needed to become more than a collection of isolated projects. It needed a clear roadmap, measurable objectives, and a repeatable process for continuous improvement.

The business also faced an interesting challenge.

The firm needed to compete in two very different search environments at the same time. Locally, success depended on maintaining strong visibility within the highly competitive New York City market. Nationally, the objective was to attract prospective clients across the United States who were researching immigration services online.

Those goals required different tactics, but they needed to support the same business strategy.

Establishing the Foundation

Before recommending changes, I wanted to understand our starting point.

I completed a comprehensive audit using Google Search Console, Semrush, Screaming Frog, Google Analytics 4, and manual website reviews to evaluate technical health, keyword visibility, content quality, local search presence, and competitive positioning. I also [incorporated AI into the research process](#) to organize findings, prioritize opportunities, and develop an implementation roadmap.

The audit confirmed there wasn't a single issue limiting performance.

Instead, there were dozens of opportunities that, when addressed systematically, could create meaningful long-term growth. That finding shaped the rest of the project. Rather than chasing isolated wins, I focused on building a structured optimization program that could continue improving over time.

Creating a Sustainable SEO Program

The first priority was measurement.

I established performance benchmarks for impressions, organic traffic, keyword rankings, local visibility, technical health, and lead generation so future decisions could be based on trends rather than assumptions. Having a consistent reporting framework also made it easier to communicate progress with leadership and prioritize future initiatives.

From there, I focused on strengthening the site's technical foundation by resolving crawl issues, improving metadata, refining heading structures, reviewing page quality, and supporting optimization efforts during a website redesign. At the same time, I implemented Semrush Listing Management and updated the firm's Google Business Profile and legal directory listings to improve consistency across local search channels.

SEO extends beyond technical improvements, so I also developed a long-term editorial strategy based on keyword research, competitive analysis, and business priorities. Instead of treating blog posts as one-off projects, I created a roadmap that balances publishing new educational content with regularly improving existing pages. AI supports research and drafting, while every article is reviewed by leadership and attorneys before publication to ensure legal accuracy, compliance, and brand consistency.

Measuring Progress

SEO is one of the few marketing disciplines where success compounds over time.

As technical improvements, local optimization, and content strategy began working together, search visibility steadily improved.

Results included:

- **192% increase in Google Search impressions**
- **94% increase in organic clicks**
- **89% increase in organic traffic**
- **110% increase in Top 3 keyword rankings**
- **Average Google position improved from 10.3 to 5.8**
- **54% increase in local map share of voice**
- **21% increase in inbound leads**

Those metrics are encouraging, but I see them as indicators of something larger. They demonstrate that the underlying process is working. As new content is published and additional geographic expansion initiatives are introduced, the same framework can continue supporting growth without needing to be redesigned.

Building for Long-Term Growth

One of the initiatives currently underway is expanding the firm's geographic SEO strategy.

After completing keyword and competitor research, I developed a framework for location-specific landing pages targeting high-opportunity immigration markets outside New York, including New Jersey, Connecticut, and Florida. The objective is to strengthen national visibility while maintaining the firm's local authority in New York City.

That reflects the broader way I think about SEO.

Rankings matter, but they're not the objective. The real value comes from creating a repeatable system that continuously improves technical quality, content relevance, user experience, and business performance over time.

Project at a Glance

Primary Focus

SEO Strategy & Organic Growth

Core Capabilities

- Technical SEO audits
- Keyword and competitor research
- Local SEO
- National SEO strategy
- Editorial planning
- Performance benchmarking
- Executive reporting

Primary Platforms

- Google Search Console
- Semrush
- Screaming Frog
- Google Analytics 4
- Google Business Profile

Business Outcomes

- +192% search impressions
- +94% organic clicks
- +89% organic traffic
- +110% Top 3 keyword rankings
- Improved average search position from **10.3 to 5.8**
- Built a scalable SEO program with ongoing governance and reporting

Designing an Intelligent Lead Routing System

Executive Summary

Speed-to-lead has a direct impact on the customer experience, but traditional CRM assignment rules often assume every team member is equally available to respond. This project focused on building a routing system that considered real-time schedule availability, reduced manual oversight, and kept lead management entirely [within the existing CRM](#) instead of introducing another software platform.

Recognizing the Real Problem

As lead volume increased, I started looking more closely at how new inquiries moved through the sales process.

The issue wasn't that leads were going unassigned. The issue was that the CRM had no awareness of whether the assigned booking specialist was actually available to receive the lead.

Someone working a later shift could receive an inquiry submitted first thing in the morning. A lead might be assigned to someone on PTO, away from their desk, or not scheduled to work at all. Supervisors spent valuable time monitoring assignments, correcting ownership manually, and making sure high-intent inquiries didn't sit unattended.

Round-robin assignment solved distribution.

It didn't solve availability.

Designing Around the Operation

Before building anything, I established a few principles that guided the project.

The routing logic needed to live inside HubSpot so it could integrate with existing contact ownership, lead creation, and task management. The scheduling process had

to remain simple enough for non-technical managers to maintain. I also wanted to avoid purchasing another routing platform when we already had the capabilities to build the solution internally.

Google Sheets became the scheduling interface because it was already familiar to the sales team. Managers could update schedules, PTO, or availability without editing workflows or touching code. The routing engine simply referenced the latest schedule and made assignment decisions automatically.

Building the Routing Engine

The question driving the entire design was straightforward:

"Who is available to take this lead right now?"

To answer that question, I combined several components into a single operational workflow.

Custom code evaluates the current day and time, reads the published schedule, identifies eligible booking team members, and assigns the lead to someone who is both scheduled to work and marked as available. HubSpot workflows then manage everything that follows, including lead creation, task assignment, retries, notifications, and exception handling.

The system also distinguishes between different operational scenarios.

Leads submitted during business hours follow a different path than after-hours inquiries. If no one is available during business hours, the workflow pauses, retries at scheduled intervals, and alerts sales leadership so the issue can be reviewed. After-hours leads are held until the next routing window before assignment begins. That separation prevented overnight leads from being treated as routing failures while still ensuring they reached the appropriate team member as quickly as possible.

I also created a separate process for contacts entered manually by reception. Instead of requiring staff to manipulate ownership fields, they simply mark a custom property indicating the record needs booking assignment, allowing the routing workflow to handle the rest automatically.

Improving Through Iteration

The finished system wasn't the first version I designed.

Initially, I implemented a "least recently assigned" approach that attempted to distribute work evenly across the booking team. During testing, however, I found that querying the CRM for each eligible agent generated too many API requests, eventually triggering rate-limit errors when multiple leads entered the workflow at the same time.

Rather than forcing the original design to work, I changed the routing method.

The revised approach distributes assignments using the contact's record ID, dramatically reducing API calls while maintaining reliable distribution. It wasn't a perfect replication of the original concept, but it was a better production solution because it prioritized stability over theoretical precision.

That experience reinforced something I've learned repeatedly in operations: the best design isn't always the most sophisticated. It's the one that remains dependable as volume increases.

Building for Long-Term Reliability

Several additional refinements emerged through testing.

I added retry logic that distinguishes between temporary staffing gaps and genuine routing failures. Slack notifications alert sales leadership when schedules need attention and notify me if the routing code encounters an unexpected error. I also adjusted workflow logic to prevent contacts from entering error paths after they had already been assigned successfully, and introduced safeguards for reception-created contacts so they could be routed consistently without additional manual work.

These weren't isolated fixes. They were improvements that made the overall system more resilient and easier to support over time.

Business Impact

The completed solution routes leads based on actual schedule availability rather than static ownership rules.

Sales leadership spends less time monitoring assignments manually. Reception follows a simpler process for manually created contacts. The routing schedule can be maintained without modifying workflows or code, and the organization avoided the cost and complexity of introducing a third-party routing platform. Most importantly, new inquiries are more likely to reach someone who is available to respond quickly, supporting a more consistent speed-to-lead process.

Project at a Glance

Primary Focus

Lead Routing Automation & Sales Operations

Core Capabilities

- CRM architecture
- Workflow automation
- Custom code design
- Sales operations
- Exception handling
- Process documentation
- Cross-functional enablement

Primary Technologies

- HubSpot Workflows
- HubSpot Custom Code Actions
- JavaScript
- Google Sheets
- Slack
- Private App Authentication

Business Outcomes

- Built an internal availability-based routing system
- Eliminated the need for a third-party routing platform
- Reduced manual oversight for sales leadership
- Improved routing reliability through retry logic and exception handling
- Created a maintainable scheduling process for non-technical users

Designing a Customer Journey Through Lifecycle Marketing

Executive Summary

Automation is most effective when it reflects how customers actually make decisions. Rather than building a series of email campaigns, I designed a lifecycle communication strategy that aligned with the firm's sales process, helping prospective clients receive the right information at the right time while giving the Sales team more capacity to focus on meaningful conversations.

Starting with the Client Experience

Prospective immigration clients rarely contact a law firm during an ordinary moment in their lives.

Many are navigating complex legal situations, comparing multiple firms, and making decisions that can affect their families and future. By the time they complete a contact form or submit a Meta Lead Ad, they're often looking for more than information. They're looking for confidence that they've found the right partner.

At the same time, the Sales team spent a significant amount of time answering the same questions, explaining the firm's process, and following up with prospective clients at different stages of their decision-making journey. While those conversations were valuable, many of them involved information that could be introduced proactively before someone ever spoke with a representative.

The opportunity wasn't simply to automate communication.

It was to create a more supportive experience for prospective clients while allowing Sales to spend more time on conversations that required empathy, expertise, and personal guidance.

Mapping the Journey Before Building Automation

Before writing a single email, I worked closely with Sales to understand every step of the client journey.

I mapped the process from the moment a lead entered the CRM through becoming a retained client, documenting operational handoffs, common questions, decision points, and the information prospects needed at each stage. I initially sketched the process on paper before formalizing it in Lucidchart, giving us a shared view of how the customer experience unfolded across Marketing, Booking, and Intake.

That exercise changed the direction of the project.

Instead of creating one long nurture campaign, I designed communications around lifecycle stages. Every message was triggered by where someone was in their relationship with the firm, not simply by how many days had passed since they submitted a form. That made the communication more relevant while keeping it aligned with the way the business already operated.

Building Personalized Communication Paths

The communication strategy follows the client's progression through the firm's sales process.

New inquiries receive confirmation that their request was received, information about the firm, and clear options for connecting with the Sales team. If contact isn't established immediately, additional communications continue educating and encouraging engagement. Once a consultation is scheduled, prospects transition into a booking journey that explains what to expect. After the consultation, they move into an intake journey that provides guidance based on the next steps toward becoming a client.

Within HubSpot, I designed modular workflows using branching logic to personalize each experience based on lifecycle stage, case type, preferred language, sales activity, and client engagement. As the program matured, I consolidated numerous individual automations into six flexible workflow frameworks, making the system easier to manage while creating a stronger foundation for future enhancements.

Building Trust Through Content

Content played an important role in the strategy.

Many prospective clients already knew the firm's CEO through social media before reaching out. I saw an opportunity to extend that familiarity into the lifecycle experience by partnering with an external production company to develop educational videos featuring the firm's attorney.

The videos addressed common concerns, explained what clients could expect during consultations, discussed sensitive topics such as VAWA, and introduced the firm's mission and approach to representation. Rather than relying exclusively on written communication, prospective clients could begin building confidence through familiar faces and consistent messaging before their first conversation with the firm.

A Framework That Continues to Evolve

The lifecycle strategy established a scalable communication framework that supports both prospective clients and the Sales team throughout the customer journey.

Performance is monitored through engagement metrics including email open rates, click-through rates, unsubscribe rates, and interactions with key calls to action. More importantly, the program continues to evolve. New educational content, Spanish-language journeys, workflow refinements, branding updates, and expanded personalization are incorporated as the firm's needs change and new opportunities emerge.

Like the other systems in this portfolio, the objective wasn't to create a finished product.

It was to build a framework that could continue improving over time.

Project at a Glance

Primary Focus

Lifecycle Marketing & Customer Journey Design

Core Capabilities

- Customer journey mapping

- Lifecycle strategy
- Marketing automation
- Workflow design
- Audience segmentation
- Sales enablement
- Multilingual communication

Primary Platforms

- HubSpot
- Lucidchart
- Video production partnership

Business Outcomes

- Created a structured lifecycle communication strategy
- Supported the Sales team with proactive customer education
- Delivered communications in English and Spanish
- Consolidated numerous workflows into six modular automation frameworks
- Built a scalable communication system that continues to evolve

Continuous Learning

Technology changes too quickly for any job description to define the limits of what I want to learn.

Some of the most valuable ideas I've brought into the workplace didn't begin as assigned projects. They started as personal experiments. A question I wanted to answer. A technology I was curious about. A weekend spent building something simply to understand how it worked.

That's why I maintain a self-hosted home lab.

It's a place where I can explore new technologies, test ideas, make mistakes, and troubleshoot problems without introducing unnecessary risk into a production environment. Over time, it has become my own research and development space, giving me the freedom to learn through hands-on experience rather than waiting until a business need forces me to catch up.

Learning by Building

Most of what I've learned hasn't come from reading about technology.

It's come from building it.

Projects in my home lab have included:

- Self-hosting applications with Docker
- Linux system administration
- Reverse proxies and secure remote access
- AI model experimentation
- Workflow automation
- Network configuration and monitoring
- Backup and disaster recovery planning
- API integrations
- Markdown-based documentation systems

Each project teaches something different, but they all contribute to the same goal: understanding how modern systems fit together.

Sometimes that means learning a new technology. Other times it means discovering why something failed, then rebuilding it in a better way. Either outcome is valuable because the process develops the kind of practical understanding that's difficult to gain from documentation alone.

Bringing Ideas Back to Work

The connection between personal learning and professional work is rarely immediate.

A workflow I build at home might influence how I approach a [CRM implementation](#) months later. Experimenting with Linux makes it easier to troubleshoot integrations and communicate with technical vendors. [Exploring AI](#) in a personal environment gives me the confidence to introduce it thoughtfully in the workplace because I already understand both its capabilities and its limitations.

Those connections aren't always obvious when I'm learning something new. Looking back, though, many of the systems in this portfolio were shaped by ideas that started as experiments outside the office.

Staying Adaptable

One lesson has become clearer every year.

Technical skills have a shelf life.

Platforms evolve. Best practices change. New tools emerge, and expectations shift just as quickly. The ability to learn continuously has become just as valuable as expertise in any single platform.

That's why I continue making time to explore, even when there isn't an immediate business need. Curiosity has consistently expanded my perspective, improved my technical judgment, and made me more comfortable solving unfamiliar problems.

For me, continuous learning isn't another professional objective.

It's simply part of how I work.

Areas of Ongoing Exploration

- Artificial intelligence and workflow automation
- Self-hosted infrastructure
- Linux administration
- Docker and containerization
- API integrations
- Knowledge management systems
- Networking and security
- Documentation frameworks
- Marketing technology
- Revenue operations
- Business systems architecture

Operating Principles

Every project in this portfolio is different.

Some focus on [CRM architecture](#). Others center on [organizational change](#), [marketing measurement](#), [AI](#), [paid media](#), [SEO](#), or [customer journey design](#). On the surface, they solve different problems.

What connects them is the way I approach the work.

Over time, I've found that organizations rarely struggle because they lack talented people or good ideas. More often, growth exposes weaknesses in the systems that support the business. Information becomes harder to find. Processes evolve without documentation. Teams develop different ways of working. Reporting becomes inconsistent. Technology accumulates faster than governance.

Those are the kinds of problems I enjoy solving.

Not because there's a single right answer, but because improving the system often improves dozens of other outcomes at the same time. Better reporting leads to better decisions. Clearer documentation makes onboarding easier. Well-designed automation creates more time for meaningful work. Thoughtful governance keeps systems maintainable as organizations grow.

The projects in this portfolio are different examples of that same pattern.

Start with the Business Problem

Technology should never be the starting point.

Before evaluating software or designing a workflow, I want to understand what's creating friction for the business. Where are people spending unnecessary time? Which decisions depend on incomplete information? What process keeps breaking down?

When those questions are answered clearly, the right solution is usually much easier to identify.

Design for the People Using the System

The most technically sophisticated solution isn't always the best one.

I've learned to design around the people who will use the system every day. That often means preserving familiar workflows, reducing unnecessary complexity, and making new processes intuitive enough that they become part of everyday work instead of something employees have to remember.

Adoption has never been an afterthought for me. It's one of the primary measures of success.

Build for What Comes Next

I rarely think about a project as something that ends.

A CRM creates the foundation for lifecycle marketing. Attribution strengthens paid media optimization. Documentation enables AI-assisted workflows. Each improvement should make the next one easier to build.

That's why I try to avoid isolated solutions. I want every project to strengthen the broader operating environment.

Keep Learning

No platform stays the same for long.

The tools I use today will evolve, and some will eventually be replaced. What lasts is the ability to understand new technology, evaluate it thoughtfully, and decide where it fits within the business.

Curiosity has become one of my most valuable professional habits because it keeps expanding the range of problems I'm prepared to solve.

Measure Success by Business Outcomes

At the end of the day, I don't measure success by the number of workflows I've built, the software I've implemented, or the certifications I've earned.

I measure it by different questions.

Did the work make it easier for people to do their jobs?

Did leaders gain better information for making decisions?

Did the systems become easier to maintain?

Did the organization become more capable than it was before?

If the answer is yes, the technology has done its job.

Closing

Thank You for Your Time

Thank you for taking the time to review my portfolio.

I hope these projects have provided a clear picture of how I approach marketing operations, business systems, and organizational growth. While every organization has its own challenges, the principles that guide my work remain consistent: understand the business, design thoughtfully, build for scale, and continue improving.

I'd welcome the opportunity to discuss how that approach could support your team and the challenges you're working to solve.

Alexis Montenegro, MBA

Marketing Operations • Revenue Operations • Business Systems • AI & Operational Strategy